fact that several Mars exploration architectures now exist, and that for cost and safety reasons, the selection of the optimal Mars Mission architecture and its implementation should begin now.

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Congressional Notes

The **"National Spaceport Act"** bill (H.R. 1631) was introduced on May 12, 1995. Its purpose is to encourage the development of the commercial space industry by promoting State-run spaceports. Its provisions require incorporating spaceports into national transportation policy, establishing a single agency for regulatory oversight, setting up tax-exempt bonding authority for spaceport infrastructure development, and promoting the conversion of military bases to spaceports. The bill has been referred to committee.

On June 28, 1995, a bill was introduced in the House (H.R. 1953) to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 for the purpose of encouraging the development of a commercial space industry in the United States. The short title of the proposed legislation is the **"Space Business Incentives Act of 1995"** which amends the Internal Revenue Code to allow a deduction, at the election of the taxpayer, for an amount equal to the aggregate amount paid during the taxable year for the purchase of qualified Commercial Space Center Stock. The maximum amount allowed during the year is not to exceed $100,000 ($50,000 in the case of a married individual filing a separate return). *Inter alia,* the bill's provisions:

(a) exclude gain on the sale or exchange of qualified space corporation stock held for more than five years, with limitations;
(b) provide for the treatment of space launch and launch support facility bonds as exempt facility bonds;
(c) exclude from gross income: (1) income from the commercial sale of any product manufactured in space and returned to Earth; and (2) income from any services performed in space in a commercial space activity;
(d) exempt a product which was manufactured in space and which was launched from and returned to Earth or manufactured at a facility in outer space from all Federal excises, imposts, and duties and any other Federal tariffs;
(e) direct the President to encourage State and local governments to offer tax and other incentives to encourage commercial space activities.

The bill has been referred to the House Ways and Means Committee.

The House passed H.R. 2043 which authorizes FY 96 appropriation for NASA programs, including human spaceflight, science, aeronautics and technology programs, and mission support.

The Senate passed S-1048 NASA Authorization Act for FY 1996. Under it, NASA would be able to continue to support its major programs,